

This roadmap
online

B.A. in Music roadmap: composition and production electives, two years for transfer students

Entry at junior standing with an Associate Degree for Transfer (AA-T) in Music · Music office:
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Degree	Entry	In residence	Catalog
Bachelor of Arts in Music	Transfer, AA-T, fall A (even years)	60 units	2027–2028

01 Units in residence

Component	Units
Music requirements and electives*	39
General education	9
Free electives**	12
Total in residence	60
AA-T	60
B.A. total	120

*Plus up to 6 units for transfer students: 3 for the keyboard sequence (MUS 118, MUS 119, and MUS 218) and 3 for MUS 202 Writing About Music.

**These vary depending on each student's path through the GE requirements and free electives, up to 120 units.

The music electives in this plan are composition and production courses. MUS 414 counts as 3 of the free elective units.

Applied lessons begin after an applied area placement: an audition on the student's instrument or voice, or a creative portfolio in composition or music production.

String players take Chamber Orchestra (MUS 365) as their Major Performing Ensemble.

02 Before the first semester

The B.A. requires three semesters of keyboard musicianship: MUS 118, MUS 119, and MUS 218. Transfer students who haven't completed the sequence take it at CSU East Bay or meet the requirement by credit by exam.

The B.A. requires MUS 202 Writing About Music. Transfer students who haven't completed GE Second Composition will need to fulfill that requirement with this course.

The B.A. requires MUS 381 Essentials of Music Technology. Transfer students who haven't completed a similar technology course will need to fulfill that requirement with this course during their first semester.

General education paths differ from student to student. The GE courses shown are one typical selection for music majors. Students build their own GE plan with an advisor.

The Certificate in Music Education counts within the B.A. units in residence, with up to 4 units beyond the 60 units in residence. Its roadmap shows the semester placement of the certificate courses.

03 Semester by semester

☐ Music ☐ General education

Fifth semester (fall A)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 4	Upper-division Social and Behavioral Sciences	3
MUS 323	Topics in Western Music History	3
MUS 312	Form and Analysis	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Composition or Music Production (applied area placement)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
MUS 303	Entrepreneurship in the Arts	3
Semester total		14

Seventh semester (fall B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 304	World Music & Culture	3
MUS 410	20th and 21st C Styles and Techniques	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Composition or Music Production (portfolio review)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
MUS 360–369	Chamber Ensemble	1
MUS 486	Advanced Sound Design II: Synthesis, Modulation & Creative Digital Signal Processing	3
MUS 414	Contemporary Orchestration and Arranging (free elective units)	3
Semester total		15

Sixth semester (spring A)

Course	Title	Units
UD GE 5	Upper-division Science and Quantitative Reasoning	3
UWR	University Writing Requirement	3
MUS 324	History of American Music	3
MUS 461–469	Applied Composition or Music Production (portfolio review)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
MUS 485	Advanced Sound Design I: Sampling, Editing, and Mixing	3
Free electives		3
Semester total		17

Eighth semester (spring B)

Course	Title	Units
MUS 461–469	Applied Composition or Music Production (portfolio review)	1
MUS 351–359	Major Performing Ensemble	1
MUS 415	MIDI Orchestration	3
Free electives		9
Semester total		14

04 Music electives

Students choose 12 units. Up to 4 additional units of Applied Music Study, 4 additional units of Major Performing Ensembles, and 7 additional units of Chamber Ensembles also count toward electives.

Music education

MUS 331 Foundations of Music Education, 3
 MUS 335 Technology for Music Educators, 3
 MUS 431 Elementary Music Teaching Methods, 3
 MUS 432 Instrumental Music Teaching Methods, 3
 MUS 433 Choral Music Teaching Methods, 3
 MUS 445 Piano Pedagogy, 2
 MUS 446 Vocal Pedagogy, 2
 MUS 495 Music Education Practicum, 1

MUS 497 Contemporary Issues in Music Education, 3

Conducting

MUS 341 Basic Conducting, 3
 MUS 441 Intermediate Conducting, 3

Composition and music production

MUS 280 Composers Workshop, 1
 MUS 412 Contrapuntal Techniques, 3
 MUS 414 Contemporary Orchestration and Arranging, 3
 MUS 415 MIDI Orchestration, 3
 MUS 485 Advanced Sound Design I: Sampling, Editing, and Mixing, 3

MUS 486 Advanced Sound Design II: Synthesis, Modulation & Creative Digital Signal Processing, 3

History and global music

MUS 305 Global Hip-Hop, 3
 MUS 326 Topics in Global Music, 3

Entrepreneurship and research

MUS 303 Entrepreneurship in the Arts, 3
 MUS 490 Independent Study, 1–3
 MUS 498 Internship, 1–3

Performance

MUS 317 Improvisation Techniques, 1